

Terms and Conditions

Rules for using the Jackson Hacks website, applying to the event, and participating in Jackson Hacks 2026.

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1. About Jackson Hacks

Jackson Hacks is a student club operating through A. Y. Jackson Secondary School and subject to applicable school and Toronto District School Board policies. These Terms apply to the Jackson Hacks website, accounts, applications, project submissions, judging, and the in-person event scheduled for November 21, 2026 from 8:00 a.m. to 10:00 p.m. Eastern Time at A. Y. Jackson Secondary School, 50 Francine Drive, North York, Ontario.

In these Terms, Event means Jackson Hacks 2026 and its related activities. Organizers means the authorized Jackson Hacks student organizers and supervising personnel acting for the Event.

2. Acceptance

By creating an account, submitting an application, submitting a project, or attending the Event, you agree to these Terms and the Code of Conduct and acknowledge the Privacy Notice. If you are under 18, a parent or legal guardian must also complete the required participant waiver before you may attend.

The application checkbox does not replace the participant waiver, guardian permission, media release, or any school-required form.

3. Eligibility

Applicants must be currently enrolled in Grade 9, 10, 11, or 12, or an equivalent high-school program, when the Event takes place. Applicants may live anywhere, but they are responsible for confirming that they can lawfully travel to and attend the Event in Toronto.

The Event is free to attend. No purchase or payment is required to apply, participate, or be eligible for a prize. Applicants must provide accurate information and may be asked to confirm their identity, age, school enrollment, eligibility, or guardian permission.

4. Accounts and applications

Each person may use one account and submit one application for the Event cycle unless an Organizer gives written permission otherwise. Account credentials may not be shared, and applicants must promptly report suspected unauthorized access.

Submitting an application does not guarantee admission. Decisions may consider eligibility, application scoring, capacity, safety, conflicts of interest, and whether information is accurate. Applicants may edit their submission until applications are closed by the Organizers. If applications are reopened and an applicant edits a previously reviewed submission, prior reviews may be invalidated.

5. Demographic survey and application review

Age is required to assess eligibility. Other demographic questions, including gender identity, pronouns, and race or ethnicity, are optional. Optional demographic answers are not used to calculate application scores or make admission decisions and are not displayed to reviewers while they score applications.

Authorized administrators may access demographic information only for the purposes described in the Privacy Notice, including aggregate inclusion and outreach reporting. Internal scores, reviewer notes, deliberations, and reviewer identities are confidential. Application decisions are final except where the Organizers identify a material technical error, conflict of interest, eligibility issue, or procedural problem.

6. Communications

Jackson Hacks may send account-security, application, consent, attendance, schedule, safety, judging, and prize messages to the contact information provided. Applicants are responsible for monitoring their email and responding by stated deadlines. Applying does not subscribe a person to unrelated marketing messages.

7. Participants under 18

A participant under 18 must provide a completed parent or guardian waiver before attending. Separate school-required permission, emergency, medical, dismissal, or media forms may also apply. Admission may be conditional and may be cancelled if required forms are not submitted by the stated deadline.

8. Attendance, departure, and transportation

Jackson Hacks does not provide transportation, accommodation, or travel documents. Participants are responsible for arriving and departing safely and for their own travel costs.

Participants may leave before the Event ends. Participants under 18 must sign out. A minor may leave unaccompanied only if advance parent or guardian permission authorizes it. Re-entry is subject to venue and security rules.

9. Safety, food, and personal property

Participants must follow venue rules and all reasonable safety directions. Jackson Hacks does not provide a hardware hub, soldering equipment, or transportation. Unsafe equipment, open flames, weapons, alcohol, illegal drugs, and activities that create unreasonable risk are prohibited.

Food may be provided by third-party vendors. The Organizers will make reasonable efforts to communicate known ingredients and dietary options but cannot guarantee an allergen-free environment or prevent cross-contact. Participants with allergies or medical needs are responsible for taking appropriate precautions and carrying necessary medication.

Participants are responsible for their devices and belongings. Lost, stolen, or damaged property should be reported promptly, but recovery is not guaranteed.

10. Conduct

All applicants, participants, volunteers, mentors, judges, sponsors, and guests must follow the Jackson Hacks Code of Conduct. Harassment, discrimination, bullying, retaliation, violence, deliberate disruption, academic dishonesty, and unauthorized access to systems or information are prohibited.

The Organizers may warn, restrict, remove, disqualify, or report a person when reasonably necessary to protect safety, fairness, property, or the Event.

11. Teams and project rules

Projects may be created by one to four participants. Substantive project work must be created during the Event. Pre-event planning, publicly available open-source software, libraries, APIs, datasets, and artificial-intelligence tools may be used if their use is lawful, permitted by applicable licenses, and clearly disclosed to judges.

Participants must not submit work they do not have the right to use, malicious software, unlawfully obtained data, exposed credentials, or content that violates another person's rights.

12. Ownership and permission to evaluate projects

Participants retain ownership of their original work. Team members are responsible for agreeing among themselves about ownership and continued use.

Each participant grants Jackson Hacks a non-exclusive, royalty-free permission to access, evaluate, display, and demonstrate the submitted project for Event administration, judging, documentation, and Event promotion. This permission does not transfer ownership of the project. Confidential information is shared at the participant's own discretion and should not be included in a public demonstration.

13. Judging and prizes

Prizes are governed by the Official Prize Rules published before project submissions open. Those rules will state the number, description, approximate value, currency, eligibility requirements, judging process, and distribution conditions. If these Terms conflict with the Official Prize Rules about prizes, the Official Prize Rules control.

Judges' decisions are final except where the Organizers identify a calculation error, conflict of interest, eligibility problem, or other material procedural issue.

14. Required photography and media permission

The Event will be photographed and recorded. Agreement to the Event's media release is a condition of in-person attendance. Participants may appear in photographs, video, audio, livestreams, interviews, project demonstrations, and other Event documentation used to report on or promote Jackson Hacks, the school community, or future Jackson Hacks events.

A participant under 18 must have a parent or guardian authorize the media release. The separate participant waiver and media release explains the permitted uses. Project ownership remains with participants.

15. Event changes

The Organizers may change the schedule, activities, speakers, judges, sponsors, venue arrangements, capacity, or prize schedule when reasonably necessary. The Event may be postponed, relocated, moved online, shortened, or cancelled because of safety, venue, legal, technical, weather, public-health, or other circumstances outside reasonable control. Reasonable efforts will be made to notify affected participants.

16. Privacy and security

Personal information is handled as described in the Privacy Notice. Application information is not public and is limited to authorized people and service providers who need it for the stated purposes.

Users must not bypass access controls, probe or exploit the website, access another person's information, upload malware, automate account creation, disrupt services, or publicly disclose a suspected vulnerability before giving Jackson Hacks a

reasonable opportunity to investigate. Security concerns should be reported privately to ayjacksonhacks@gmail.com.

17. Third-party services

The website may use third-party hosting, authentication, database, email, analytics, and other operational services. It may also link to sponsor or partner websites. Third parties have their own terms and privacy practices, and a link or logo does not mean Jackson Hacks controls their services.

18. Disclaimers and limitation of liability

Jackson Hacks will take reasonable steps to operate the website and Event safely and reliably but cannot guarantee uninterrupted service, admission, project success, employment opportunities, or receipt of a prize.

To the maximum extent permitted by law, Jackson Hacks and its Organizers are not responsible for indirect, incidental, special, or consequential losses arising from the website, an application decision, an Event change, or participation. Nothing in these Terms limits a right or responsibility that applicable law does not permit the parties to exclude. In-person risks and required permissions are addressed in the separate participant waiver.

19. Suspension and disqualification

An account, application, invitation, participation privilege, project, score, or prize may be suspended or revoked for ineligibility, material misrepresentation, duplicate or fraudulent accounts, unsafe behaviour, cheating, security abuse, or violation of these Terms, the Code of Conduct, school policy, venue rules, or law. When appropriate and practical, the affected person will be given an opportunity to clarify the situation.

20. Changes, governing law, and contact

These Terms are governed by the laws of Ontario and the applicable federal laws of Canada. If a provision is unenforceable, the remaining provisions continue to apply.

Material changes will be posted with an updated version date, and reasonable efforts will be made to notify affected applicants or participants. A later change will not be applied solely to unfairly disqualify an applicant or remove an already-earned prize.

Questions may be sent to the Jackson Hacks organizing team at ayjacksonhacks@gmail.com.